

- To clear a pending alerts right away, press the X sign where available, and then the “Clear” button.
- To access a notification, tap it and you’re taken to the related email, reminder, message or app. The notification then clears automatically from the Center.

Better still, you can customize notifications the way you want from Settings > Notifications.

How to Use a Keyboard Shortcut (iOS 5 only)

Need to type and re-type certain phrases over and over again? Then why not use a keyboard shortcut so that you type faster and it saves your time. This feature is available in iOS 5 and you can set a keyboard shortcut easily.

- Go to Settings > General > Keyboard.
- Tap “Add New Shortcut”
- Enter a phrase, e.g. in my opinion
- Enter a shortcut, e.g. imo
- Tap “Save”.

The next time you type a shortcut, e.g. imo, the system will suggest expanding it to a phrase that you’ve set.

How to access Brightness

The iPad screen is extraordinarily bright, this is wonderful for daytime use but give your eyes some rest in dimmer environments and at night time by manually adjusting the brightness, just double-tap the Home button and swipe right until you see the brightness indicator, and adjust manually as the lighting fits.

How to selectively prevent automatic sync

Sometimes you don’t want to sync your iPad when you connect it to your computer. In that case, hold down Shift-Ctrl (or Command-Option, on a Mac) in iTunes while plugging your iPad in, and iTunes will skip the automatic sync just this once. Alternatively, you can safely interrupt a sync by dragging the unlock slider on your device while the iPad is midsync. 